

Action plan 2026

Here we outline the main focus areas and actions for 2026 to advance our strategic goals.

This action plan translates our [overall strategy](#) into concrete initiatives. The five strategic guidelines form the foundation for all our activities. They directly or indirectly permeate every part of our work within education, research, outreach, and organization.

The plan is organized as follows: First, we highlight the core priorities for each strategic guideline, as defined in our strategy. We then restate our goals and present the specific 2026 focus areas within education, research, outreach, and organization. Finally, we summarize our key performance indicators (KPIs).

Social responsibility: We will ensure that ERS dimensions - Ethics, Responsibility and Sustainability - permeates all programmes.

Soft skills and competence for change: We will improve soft skills dimensions on all programs and ensure that students are trained in teamwork, negotiations and presentation skills. We will further develop academic and social arenas that encourage collaboration, curiosity, and a vibrant student community.

Solution-oriented research: We will mobilize for interdisciplinary collaboration on larger research projects and facilitate research collaboration with both industry and public sector.

Connection to Practice: We will strengthen ties to work life by expanding internships and formal collaborations across all programs, better prepare students to work life, and systematically engage alumni and industry representatives.

Internationalization: We will revitalize exchange agreements and develop structured international internships. We will prioritize mutually beneficial partnerships, double degree opportunities, and deeper integration of international perspectives across education, research, and practice.

I. Education

Goals:

- High intake quality - motivated and academically strong students.
- High study quality - well-being and learning outcomes.
- High candidate quality - attractiveness in the labor market.

Focus areas:

- Strengthening the first year of all bachelor programs.
 - Strengthen teaching resources.

- Enhance follow-up through seminar groups, mentoring schemes, and improved academic and social meeting arenas.
- Strengthen AI competence among faculty in order to improve teaching quality and ensure students are trained in responsible and effective use of AI.
 - Offer AI training seminars and establish a platform for knowledge sharing among teachers.
 - Revise our AI strategy considering new practices and in accordance with UiS AI strategy
- Broaden the international dimension of our education
 - Develop international internship agreements
 - Revitalize the exchange program and develop new partnerships.
 - Expand opportunities for double degrees.
- Better prepare students for work life.
 - Expand business collaboration by improving internship, mentoring programs and industry guest lectures.
 - Supporting student-led initiatives that promote closer contact with employers.

II. Research

Goals:

- High share of publications in top international journals.
- High share of publications in internationally recognized scientific journals.
- High share of external funding.
- Solid PhD education.
- Impact beyond the scientific sphere. Public policy and real-world business challenges.

Focus areas:

- Strengthen PhD education.
 - Improve PhD supervision and training
 - Evaluate the organization of the PhD education
- Increase baseline research funding
 - Raise operating funds per faculty member.
 - Strengthen internal funding for project development and research collaboration.

III. Outreach

Goals:

- Dissemination of research to a broad set of stakeholders, practitioners, and users.
- Long-term partnerships with selected external stakeholders.
- Visibility in the public debate.
- Facilitate professional meeting places for networking and debate.
- Participation in boards and public policy committees.
- Further developing the alumni network.

Focus areas:

- Strengthen service, hospitality, and tourism profile
 - Establish a dedicated role (e.g., center director) for strategic development.
 - Position the business School as a national meeting place for the service industry.
 - Develop and improve partnerships with the service industry.
- Increase engagement with work life
 - Improve internships and formal collaboration with work life across programs.
 - Evaluate and further develop executive education, alumni network and lifelong learning opportunities.

IV. Organization

Goals:

- Attractive workplace.
- Good and inclusive working environment for both faculty and students.
- Ensure quality international recruitment and the integration of international faculty.
- Faculty involvement in decision-making processes.
- High-standard infrastructure to facilitate a good working and learning environment.

Focus areas:

- Develop a new strategy for the new business school
 - Conduct an inclusive strategy process involving faculty, staff, students, and external stakeholders.
- Ensure smooth organizational and cultural integration of NHS-ILT into HHUis.
 - Establish clear communication channels and joint arenas to build trust, collaboration, and shared identity.
- Strengthen and consolidate the law program
 - Recruit new faculty to ensure critical mass and academic robustness.
 - Define and allocate responsibilities for program leadership to strengthen management, reduce vulnerability and secure reaccreditation
- Ensure progress toward international accreditation
 - Prepare and apply for Equis eligibility
 - Engage faculty and administrative staff in the accreditation process.
- Evaluate onboarding, follow-up, and integration of new faculty.
 - Gather systematic feedback, in particular from international hires, to improve support systems and long-term retention.

Key performance indicators

Our key performance indicators represent long-term quality and performance goals for the UiS Business School. They serve as overarching measures of success across all strategic areas — education, research, outreach, and organization.

We do not set fixed numerical targets for 2026. Instead, our ambition is to achieve continuous improvement on all key indicators over time. The actions outlined in this plan are expected to strengthen performance gradually — for example, through improved student recruitment, higher research quality, greater internationalization, and stronger employee engagement.

The KPIs are monitored annually and benchmarked against national and international peers to ensure steady progress and alignment with our long-term strategic objectives.

Key performance indicators	2022	2024/2025
Primary applicants pr study place on each program (her kan legges ved egen tabell for hvert program)	3	4,5 (2254 1.pri appl /497 study places)
Grades of the applicants 2025	51,2/48,1/C	50/C
Average teaching evaluation scores on course Evaluations	3,8	3,85
Satisfaction rates on programme evaluations (study barometer) 2024	3,8	3,8
First year drop out rate	20%	12%
Wage among newly graduated students	600 000	
Proportion of students on international student exchange	2%/4%	3,6%/9,1%
Number of incoming exchange students	51	48
Number of international degree students (møtt)	65	12
Annual credits per students 2024	46,5/44,5	46,7/48

Key performance indicators	2022	2024
Number of publications in ABS journal guide 4 and 4*	18	11
Number of publications in ABS journal guide 3	18	19
Publication points (DBH)	1.32	1.21
Numbers of externally funded research projects	20	7
Total external funding as a proportion of state funding	24%	28,6
Number of PhD graduations/dissertations	3	6
Number of graduating PhD students placed in peer academic institutions	3	4

Key performance indicators	2022	2024
Dissemination data (NVA)	298	167
Media appearances	247	346

Key performance indicators	2022	2024
Employee survey (summary index)		3,7 (2025)
Proportion of women in professorial positions	30,4%	25%
Proportion of international faculty	40%	44%